

The CA Firm Strategy is designed to take an accounting or advisory firm from disorganized operational chaos to a structured, highly profitable advisory practice. The framework guides you through five sequential phases: Planning, Packaging, Coaching, Sales, and Delivery.

This material is aimed for firm principles only and is developed to help you plan the growth of individual team members as you package your strategic service offerings.

Detailed Guide to Key Templates and Frameworks

1. Capacity Planner & Target Models (My Fee Growth Model / Plan)

- Benefits: These calculators define the precise logistics of delivering advisory services while maintaining compliance. They reveal growth opportunities and define "time budgets" for the team based on client base size and skills.
- How it helps the Advisor: The *My Fee Growth Plan* helps advisors define target clients, niche service offers, and marketing statements, making them more confident in their engagement tasks. The *Team Advisory Targets* table clearly summarizes fee targets, client focus, and time expectations, removing ambiguity.
- How it helps the Business Owner: Ensures that clients are accurately categorized (Growth, Maintain, Service) so they receive the appropriate level of dedicated time and resources.
- Suitable for: Firm leaders mapping total capacity, and individual advisors (with full or shared autonomy) tasked with growing a fee base.

2. Team Training O.S. & Coaching Progress Plan

- Benefits: Defines the functional skills team members need to improve and tailors the coaching content to the team's experience and budget.
- How it helps the Advisor: By scheduling learning on a "work sprint" basis, it structures sessions around peak workflow commitments, preventing task avoidance during busy compliance periods.
- How it helps the Business Owner: Ensures the professionals advising them are undergoing continuous, structured improvement.
- Suitable for: Firm Managers, Internal Coaches, and all team members.

3. Growth Curve Checklist

- Benefits: Aligns the firm's strategic service offerings directly with the age and developmental stage of the client's business.
- How it helps the Advisor: Acts as a roadmap to unlock cross-selling potential. It empowers the advisor to "push" relevant service solutions (e.g., succession planning for mature businesses) into the client's service plan.

- How it helps the Business Owner: Ensures the advice they receive is contextually relevant to their current position (e.g., Design, Launch, Growth, Maturity).
- Suitable for: All client-facing advisors.

4. Strategic Evaluation Frameworks (Tech Review & Offshoring Review)

- Benefits: Provides structured ways to make difficult firm decisions without emotion. The *Technology Review* utilizes the Everett Rogers Diffusion of Innovation Theory and Porter's 5 Forces to evaluate tech and AI. The *Offshoring Review* utilizes Edward De Bono's 6 Hats framework to remove confirmation bias.
- How it helps the Advisor/Firm Manager: Prevents "shiny object syndrome" with technology and ensures a balanced exploration of offshoring pros and cons.
- Suitable for: The Partner Group and Firm Directors.

5. Contrast Models (FM Expectations and FM Stages)

- Benefits: Often described as the best "bang for buck" planning tools, these tables map out the interrelatedness of the owners' aspirations and the sequential business development objectives required to achieve them.
- Suitable for: Partners, Directors, and Firm Managers defining their "End Game".

6. Tracking & Accountability Software (Global Actions Report & CPD Log)

- Benefits: Centralizes accountability. The *Global Actions Report* summarizes all actions promised to clients, and the *CPD Log* tracks all learning.
- How it helps the Advisor: Automates reminders so nothing is forgotten post-meeting.
- How it helps the Business Owner: Translates advice into real-world action, providing evidence of progress and effectiveness "in the field".
- Suitable for: Firm Management tracking performance, and Advisors tracking their daily tasks.

Step-by-Step Practical Implementation

To roll this framework out effectively, follow the 5-step Advisor-e Architecture:

- **Step 1: Planning (Assess & Categorize)**
 - Compile your family-grouped accounts into the Capacity Planner.
 - Categorize your clients into *Growth*, *Maintain*, and *Service* tiers based on their fee potential and importance.
 - Use the Strategic Services Summary and Internal Functions Summary to assign "champions" to specific service lines and operational duties.

- **Step 2: Packaging (Align Services)**
 - Review the Growth Curve Checklist to brainstorm and align your service offers with the different lifecycle stages of your clients.
 - Use the Advisory Pricing Model to structure different rates for preparation, travel, and delivery.
- **Step 3: Coaching (Train the Team)**
 - Ensure advisors complete the My Fee Growth Model to set their personal conversion assumptions.
 - Conduct internal training using Team AI (Familiarity) Tasks to teach the team how to prompt AI and use basic automation. Guide them to track their learning in the CPD Table.
- **Step 4: Sales (Engage the Client)**
 - Utilize EOY (End of Year) meetings and Revenue Model meetings to develop deliberate, repeatable discovery processes.
 - Record the client's position on the Growth Curve to flush out long-term vision and short-term concerns.
- **Step 5: Delivery (Track & Refine)**
 - Use the Dashboard / Volatility Report in your service delivery to easily explain financial performance to clients.
 - Utilize the Global Actions Report and Advisor Action Plan to set automated reminders for client commitments, ensuring tasks are completed and measurable outcomes are achieved.

Common Q&A

Q1: How do we objectively evaluate implementing AI or new software?

Answer: Utilize the Technology Review document. It uses the Everett Rogers Diffusion of Innovation theory to determine your adoption appetite, and applies Porter's 5 Forces to analyze expectations and market pressures before adopting AI.

Q2: We are divided on whether to use offshore staff. How do we resolve this?

Answer: Use the Offshoring Review template, which utilizes Edward De Bono's 6 Hats Framework. This allows the partner group to separate facts (White Hat), emotions (Red Hat), risks (Black Hat), and benefits (Yellow Hat) without arguments or confirmation bias.

Q3: How do we prevent 'Service' level clients from consuming our capacity?

Answer: Adhere strictly to the Client Service Standards. Ensure that 'Growth' and 'Maintain' clients receive priority. For 'Service' clients, provide automated or scalable touchpoints (like Dashboard reports and templates) but place them at the back of the queue when workflow is compressed.

Q4: Do we use the exact same improvement plan for all staff members?

Answer: No. Use the My Fee Growth Plan for advisors responsible for expanding the firm's client base and generating revenue. For internal staff or team members not required to grow fees, use the My Improvement Plan to guide their internal performance reviews.

Q5: How do we ensure our advisory team actually completes their required training?

Answer: Use the Coaching Progress Plan to schedule learning in "work sprints" that respect peak workflow. Pair this with the CPD Table to track hours, and prioritize their "Weekly Golden Hr" for strategic learning above compliance deliveries.

Document Sources Summary Table

Template Name	Core Focus & Contents
Team Training O.S	Defines team members and the functional skills they need to improve; acts as a simple coaching outcome statement table.
Coaching Progress Plan	Tailors coaching content based on experience and budget; schedules learning on a 'work sprint' basis around peak workflow to prevent task avoidance.
Capacity Planner	Calculates the logistics of delivering advisory vs. compliance services. Identifies firm-wide growth opportunities and guides client transition planning.
My Fee Growth Model	A calculator for individuals to set personal sales activity and conversion rate assumptions to grow their fee base.

My Fee Growth Plan		Guides individual advisors in defining target clients, service niches, and marketing statements to confidently engage new clients.
Team Targets	Advisory	Summarizes fee targets, client focus (new vs. existing), autonomy levels, and time expectations for all fee-growing advisors.
Our Summary Document	Strategic	A master template to capture strategic thoughts, monitor KPI performance, identify Porter's 5 Forces, and track business stage growth.
FM Expectations and FM Stages		Also known as 'Contrast Models', these tables map out the interrelatedness of aspirations and the sequential objectives needed to achieve them.
Strategic Summary	Services	A visual summary detailing which services to develop (e.g., Financial Systems, Valuations), which to avoid, and assigning a firm champion to each.
Vital Functions Summary	Internal	Identifies critical internal tasks (e.g., Workflow, IT, DB Management) and designates whether they are handled in-house or outsourced, along with an assigned champion.
Client Service Std's		Categorizes clients into Growth, Maintain, and Service tiers, aligning specific service actions and templates to each category to differentiate service levels.
Technology Review		Guides the firm through evaluating software and AI using the Everett Rogers Diffusion curve and Porter's 5 Forces framework to prevent impulsive adoption.
Off-shoring Review		Examines the strategic and operational pros and cons of off-shoring by deploying Edward De Bono's 6 Hats Critical Thinking Framework.

Schedule Pricing	Based	Explores introducing 'scheduling fees' to penalize queue-jumping and protect planned workflow during peak quarters.
Partner Accountability Matrix		A behavioral disciplining framework for partners, categorizing conflict domains by risk and tying them to a profit-share points system.
My Improvement Plan		An internal performance review template designed specifically for advisors who are <i>not</i> required to grow fees or manage key accounts.
CPD Table		A software tracking log for advisory learning progress, generating reports for association points and feeding into a firm-wide learning matrix.
Advisor Action Plan		An automated reminder system with "look-thru" management capabilities to record targets, objectives, and specific actions for individual client accounts.
Growth Checklist	Curve	Aligns strategic service offerings with the specific age and stage of clients. Links directly to client action plans to unlock service potential.
Global Actions Report		Summarizes all actions undertaken by advisors across all clients, allowing management to spot failures, identify automation opportunities, and track effectiveness.
Practice Objectives & Actions		A detailed checklist suggesting specific actions to build platforms, ring-fence talent, formalize networks, acquire fee bases, and build capacity.

Logic Branch Mapping (If-Then Logic Table)

Logic Branch	IF (Condition Trigger)	/ THEN (Action / Next Step)	Additional Context / Notes
Strategic Decision Making	IF the partner group is evaluating a divisive operational strategy (e.g., Offshoring or major structural change)...	THEN deploy the "Offshoring Review" and use the "6 Hats Framework".	Ensure the chairperson forces all members to wear the same "Hat" at the same time to prevent emotional arguments and confirmation bias.
Technology Adoption	IF the firm wants to test a new AI platform or software suite...	THEN run the "Team AI (Familiarity) Tasks" and apply the "Software Assessment Criteria".	Have team members test inputs across multiple AI models (Gemini, ChatGPT) to learn logic parameters, then compare outputs for bias and accuracy.
Capacity Management	IF workflow is overwhelmed and deadlines are at risk of being missed...	THEN review the "Client Service Stds" table.	Ensure that any necessary service delays or reduced contact hours are absorbed by 'Service' tier clients, protecting the 'Growth' and 'Maintain' client base.
Advisor Role Assignment	IF a team member is given the objective of expanding the firm's client base and building a book of business...	THEN assign the "My Fee Growth Model" and "My Fee Growth Plan".	Require the advisor to complete their activity targets and conversion assumptions independently before partner review to maximize buy-in.

Service Strategy & Alignment	IF you are determining which advisory fundamentals to scope for a specific business owner...	THEN deploy the "Growth Curve Checklist".	This ensures service suggestions are perfectly aligned with the business owner's current lifecycle stage, preventing irrelevant pitches.
Tracking & Accountability	IF management needs to verify that advisory advice is translating into completed tasks...	THEN run the "Global Actions Report".	Pulls data from all individual Advisor Action Plans to provide a firm-wide view of task completion, revealing bottlenecks and measuring field effectiveness.
